MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 20

"Bandage"

Episode 2x20. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x20. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, March 13, 2006, 6:02 AM through 11:58 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x19

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Monday, March 13, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, March 13, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (on leave; evaluation day)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband (pre-cranioplasty)	Apr 3, 1975	30
Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr.	Elxa's son (5 weeks)	Feb 5, 2006	0
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern (post-call; babysitter)	Feb 10, 1979	27
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Nnamdi Okoye	Surgical Resident (PGY-4)	Oct 1, 1974	31
Harlan Moody (new)	Patient: retired NYPD sergeant; retained bullet migrating into the RV	Nov 11, 1944	61
Geneva Moody (new)	Harlan's wife	May 25, 1947	58
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	50
Antoinette 'Toni' Graham (new)	Patient: distal radius fracture; domestic violence	Oct 17, 1971	34
Vaughn Graham (new)	Toni's husband	Dec 2, 1967	38
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Victor Donohue (V.O.)	Marc's grandfather	May 30, 1933	72
Celia Montague, LCSW	Hospital Social Worker	May 6, 1966	39
Dr. Eugene Pratt	Surgical Program Director	Nov 14, 1948	57
Dr. Malcolm Sloan	Chief of Plastic Surgery	Feb 14, 1968	38
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: LVAD, day 122, infection resolving	Aug 8, 1971	34
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	46
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother; P.S. 118 cafeteria	Feb 14, 1952	54
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	61
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Det. Rochelle Ames (new)	NYPD 103rd Precinct	Sep 9, 1964	41
Dr. Faith Danforth	Veterinarian	Nov 2, 1972	33
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	35
Dr. Paulette Greenidge	Couples therapist	Aug 1, 1955	50
Glenda Duvall	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Howard Divine	Harmony's father	Aug 30, 1950	55
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	47
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Mercy	The House's pit bull (5.5 months)	Sep 30, 2005	0
Ruth Bader Ginsburg (new)	Faith's three-legged ex-racing greyhound	Mar 1, 2001	5

Also appearing: a CT tech, a radiologist, scrub and CVICU nurses, two security guards, a Safe Horizon night manager and lunch-rush cafeteria diners. Mentioned: Gordon Parks (d. March 7, 2006), Denise (Toni's sister, Mount Vernon), Augustin Toussaint (his Mardi Gras words), Dr. Leonard Baker (photo) and Kennerly's statement (in the safe).

COLD OPEN

1 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - KITCHEN - PRE-DAWN
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:02 AM

A kitchen in the chaos of new parenthood. Bottles drying on a rack. A breast pump on the counter. Tuck, five weeks old, screams in a bouncy seat on the table. Elxa (28), in a blouse and suit skirt for the first time since January, a burp cloth over one shoulder, paces with a cordless phone. Russell (30), in his padded helmet, sits at the table with a coffee, looking helpless.

ELXA
(into the phone)
Lillian Divine's at the school until three. (beat) My mother has a radical hysterectomy at seven. (beat) My father has a valve at seven-thirty. (beat) Russell has neuro-rehab at nine and he isn't allowed to lift anything heavier than a coffee mug for another week. (beat) Dr. Pratt's evaluation can't be moved. (beat) He said so. (beat) Twice.

She listens. Her face falls.

ELXA
(beat)
No, Harmony, I know you're on call. (beat) I know. (beat) Okay. (beat) Thank you, baby. (beat) Bye.

She hangs up and stares at the phone. Tuck screams.

RUSSELL
(beat, carefully)
Who's left?

ELXA
(beat, scrolling through her phone)
Everybody I trust is either in an operating room or forbidden to lift him. (beat) Except one person. (beat) Who's post-call. (beat) Who hates babies. (beat) And who once told me that "children are a scheduling problem."

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you in surgery that you can't put a bandage on a bullet hole.

2 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - AMOND'S ROOM - PRE-DAWN
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:09 AM

Darkness. A spare, immaculate bedroom: stacks of cardiac journals, a framed photograph of a man in scrubs, Dr. Leonard Baker. Amond (27), post-call, face-down on the bed in his clothes, asleep for exactly forty minutes. His cell phone rings on the nightstand. He gropes for it.

AMOND
(into the pillow)
Baker.

ELXA (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Baker. (beat) It's Elxa Bullock. (beat) I need you to babysit my son from eight-thirty until noon.

Amond lifts his head off the pillow. He stares at the phone. A long pause.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm sorry. (beat) I think I'm having a stroke. (beat) Could you repeat that?

ELXA (V.O.)
(beat)
You're post-call. (beat) You're the only person I trust with him who isn't in an operating room. (beat) Three and a half hours. (beat) I'll leave instructions. (beat) Six pages.

AMOND
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) I'm a cardiothoracic surgeon.

ELXA (V.O.)
(beat)
You're an intern, Baker. (beat) Until noon, you're a babysitter. (beat) Eight-thirty. (beat) Linden Boulevard. (beat) Don't be late.

The line clicks off. Amond lies back on the bed and stares at the ceiling.

MARC (V.O.)
A wound that deep has to be opened, cleaned, sewn shut from the inside out. (beat) A bandage just hides it.

Down the hall, Marc's door opens. He leans in the doorway in his robe, grinning.

MARC
(beat)
I heard. (beat) The walls are thin.

AMOND
(beat, not moving)
Don't.

MARC (V.O.)
The trouble is, most of us would rather wear the bandage.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:31 AM

The kitchen. Spring sunlight through the window for the first time in weeks. Raven (26) and Harmony (26) at the table. Mercy, now five and a half months old and almost full-sized, lies under the table chewing her chocolate-bar toy. Marc pours coffee, humming. Raven watches him.

RAVEN
(beat)
You're humming.

MARC
(beat)
I'm not humming.

HARMONY
(beat)
You're humming. (beat) Stevie Wonder. (beat) "Isn't She Lovely." (beat) You've been humming it since the Saturday before last.

Marc sets down the coffee pot.

MARC
(beat)
It was a good dinner.

RAVEN
(beat)
You told us that. (beat) Eight times. (beat) The octopus was terrible cold and great hot. (beat) She ordered for you in Greek because she learned Greek from the baker downstairs from her. (beat) She told the waiter to take back the wine because it was corked, and she was right.

HARMONY
(beat)
And afterward she took you on the back of the Vespa over the Pulaski Bridge at midnight.

MARC
(beat, smiling into his coffee)
And she drove me home and said goodnight on the stoop. (beat) That's all.

RAVEN
(beat)
And tonight?

MARC
(beat)
Tonight she's cooking. (beat) Her place. (beat) Above the clinic. (beat) She has a three-legged greyhound named Ruth Bader Ginsburg.

HARMONY
(beat, putting down her fork)
Marc-Anthony. (beat) You like her.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
She's easy, Double-O. (beat)
Nothing about her is complicated.
(beat) I didn't know it could be
like that.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:56 AM

The interns change. Esther (26) sits on the bench. Harmony comes in and opens her locker beside her. Kennerly (27), Arianna (26) and Raven at the far end.

ESTHER
(beat, too casual)
How was it? (beat) His date.
(beat) The vet.

Harmony glances at her.

HARMONY
(beat, carefully)
Esther.

ESTHER
(beat)
I'm asking as a friend.

HARMONY
(beat)
It was good. (beat) He's humming.

ESTHER
(beat, very
quietly)
He's humming.

HARMONY
(beat)
Stevie Wonder.

Esther looks down at her hands. She ties her shoes and doesn't look up again.

ESTHER
(beat)
Good. (beat) That's good. (beat) He deserves to hum.

At the end of the bench, Kennerly is tying an actual tie: Gloria's dark-blue silk, in a perfect Windsor. Arianna stares at him.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Why are you wearing a tie on a Monday?

KENNERLY
(beat, adjusting the knot)
Kendra's coming to meet me for lunch. (beat) In the cafeteria. (beat) In front of everybody. (beat) Third date. (beat) I'm told the third one matters.

ARIANNA
(beat, flatly)
Who told you that?

KENNERLY
(beat)
Monty. (beat) And Miss Hattie. (beat) Separately.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 7:06 AM

Dr. Okoye (31) runs the board. The interns gather. A copy of the Daily News lies on the counter with a photograph on the front page: a man with a camera and a fedora. "GORDON PARKS, 1912-2006."

OKOYE
(reading off)
Bullock, Divine: Lowery, the ER. (beat) Ellison: Cardio, Dr. Robert Bullock, a retained bullet in the ER. (beat) Smilley: Neuro. (beat) Cummings: Crump, the quints' follow-up clinic. (beat) Kennerly: Cardio with Ellison. (beat) Baker is post-call and, I am told, babysitting the son of a third-year surgical resident in St. Albans.

The interns erupt. Okoye waits for it to pass.

OKOYE
(beat, dry)
Dr. Bullock left me instructions for this too. (beat) "If Baker calls in a panic, do not help him. (beat) It builds character."

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 3 - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 7:24 AM

HARLAN MOODY (61), a retired NYPD sergeant, barrel-chested, a Knights of Columbus pin on his jacket, sits on the gurney pale and short of breath, one hand pressed to his chest. His wife, GENEVA MOODY (58), stands beside him. Robert (50), Raven and Kennerly study a chest X-ray on the light box: in the middle of the heart shadow, a bright, bullet-shaped object.

HARLAN
(wheezing)
Christmas Eve, 1988. (beat) A domestic call in Jamaica. (beat) Thirty-eight caliber. (beat) Went in under my vest, right here. (beat) The surgeons at Jamaica Hospital said it was lodged in the muscle of my chest wall. (beat) "Safer to leave it." (beat) Eighteen years, I never felt it. (beat) Saturday I started getting short of breath.

ROBERT
(beat, studying the film)
It's not in your chest wall anymore, Sergeant. (beat) It's moved.

RAVEN
(beat, comparing it with an old film from 1988)
It's eight centimeters medial from where it was. (beat) It's in the heart.

ROBERT
(beat)
Or in the pericardium, next to it. (beat) Echo. (beat) CT. (beat) Now.

GENEVA
(frightened)
How does a bullet move?

ROBERT
(beat, gently)
Slowly, Mrs. Moody. (beat) Over years. (beat) Scar tissue loosens. (beat) Muscle contracts around it a hundred thousand times a day. (beat) Eventually, it finds a way.

HARLAN
(beat, trying to joke)
Eighteen years. (beat) The bullet outlasted my first marriage.

KENNERLY
(beat, dry)
It's outlasted a lot of things, Sergeant. (beat) It might be time it left.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 8 - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 7:47 AM

ANTOINETTE "TONI" GRAHAM (34), a school secretary, sits on the gurney in a cardigan, holding an ice pack to her left wrist. A purpling bruise covers her left cheekbone, mostly hidden under concealer. Her husband, VAUGHN GRAHAM (38), a car-service dispatcher in a leather jacket, stands beside her with his hand on her shoulder. Lowery, Marc and Harmony.

VAUGHN
(pleasant, too quick)
She fell down the stairs. (beat) Again. (beat) She's so clumsy. (beat) Aren't you, baby?

TONI
(beat, not looking up)
I'm clumsy.

Harmony takes the ice pack away gently and looks at the wrist: swollen, deformed. She looks at the bruise on the cheek. Then at Toni's other arm, where the cardigan sleeve has ridden up: four small, oval bruises in a row on the upper arm. Fingertips.

HARMONY
(beat, very gently)
Mrs. Graham. (beat) Can you make a fist for me?

Toni tries and winces.

LOWERY
(beat)
Distal radius fracture. (beat) X-ray. (beat) Dr. Divine, get her films. (beat) Mr. Graham, would you step out to registration for a few minutes? (beat) We need her insurance card.

VAUGHN
(beat, not moving)
I have it right here. (beat) I'll stay with my wife.

He hands over the card. His other hand stays on Toni's shoulder. Harmony looks at the hand. Then at Marc. Marc has seen it too.

TONI
(beat, barely)
He can stay.

8 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - LIVING ROOM - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 8:29 AM

The living room. A playpen. A purple birthing ball, now used as a footstool. Elxa, in her suit, puts on her earrings with one hand and holds Tuck with the other. Russell has gone to rehab. The doorbell. She opens it. Amond stands on the step in a pressed shirt, holding a cardiology journal and a cup of coffee like a man reporting for a firing squad.

ELXA
(beat)
You're two minutes early.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm always two minutes early.

She hands him the baby. Amond holds Tuck out in front of him, at arm's length, like a cardiac specimen.

ELXA
(beat)
Closer. (beat) Against your chest. (beat) He won't bite. (beat) He doesn't have teeth.

Amond pulls Tuck against his chest, stiffly. Tuck looks up at him and blinks. Elxa hands him six stapled pages.

ELXA
(beat)
Bottles in the fridge, four ounces, warm them in the bowl, never the microwave. (beat) Diapers on the changing table. (beat) Burp him over your shoulder, not your knee. (beat) He likes Coltrane. (beat) Daddy's influence. (beat) If he has a fever, you call Dr. Crump. (beat) If he stops breathing, you call 911 and then you call me. (beat) If you lose him, you move to Los Angeles and never come back.

AMOND
(beat, reading the pages)
Page four says "He likes to be told about the heart."

ELXA
(beat, grabbing her briefcase)
My father reads him the anatomy of the heart at night. (beat) He falls asleep at the tricuspid valve. (beat) Every time. (beat) Noon, Baker.

The door closes. Amond stands alone in the living room with a five-week-old baby. Tuck looks up at him. His face crumples. He screams.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 8:44 AM

Natasha (47), in scrubs, minutes before a radical hysterectomy, takes a call at her desk. The Daily News with Gordon Parks's photograph lies on her blotter.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(on the phone)
He photographed me once. (beat) Gordon. (beat) 1968. (beat) For Life magazine. (beat) A story about Black doctors. (beat) I was thirty-five. (beat) He told me to stop smiling like I'd been given something and start smiling like I'd built it.

NATASHA
(beat, smiling)
Did you?

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat)
I've been trying for thirty-eight years. (beat) Natasha. (beat) It's March. (beat) I've waited a month since the bomb. (beat) When?

Natasha looks out the window toward the hospital, her hospital, built on her own name.

NATASHA
(beat)
June, Daddy. (beat) When the intern year ends. (beat) When he's not an intern anymore and nobody can say a Donohue was handed anything in his first year. (beat) He'll have earned every single day of it on his own. (beat) Then you tell him what you've decided. (beat) In front of whoever he wants in the room.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat, a long pause)
June. (beat) I'll be seventy-three.

NATASHA
(beat)
You'll be seventy-three and you'll be there, Daddy. (beat) Don't you dare be anything else.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RADIOLOGY - CT READING ROOM - MORNING
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 9:06 AM

Robert, Raven and Kennerly behind the radiologist. On the screen, slice by slice: the bullet, a bright starburst of metal artifact, lodged in the wall of the right ventricle, its nose poking into the chamber. Around the heart, a dark crescent of fluid.

RADIOLOGIST
(beat)
Retained projectile, right ventricular free wall, partly intracavitary. (beat) Moderate pericardial effusion. (beat) It's eroded through.

ROBERT
(very calm)
It's been sitting on the outside of his heart for eighteen years. (beat) Now it's trying to get in. (beat) If it goes all the way into the ventricle, it embolizes to his lung. (beat) If it tears the wall...

Alarms from the CT scanner room. Through the glass: Harlan Moody, on the scanner table, gasping, clawing at his chest. The tech shouts.

CT TECH
(shouting)
His pressure's dropping! (beat) Seventy! (beat) Sixty!

RAVEN
(beat, already moving)
Tamponade.

ROBERT
(grabbing the phone)
OR One. (beat) Now. (beat) Pericardiocentesis tray to CT. (beat) Dr. Ellison, with me.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 9:31 AM

Harlan Moody on the table, his chest open, a needle drain still taped in place from the emergency pericardiocentesis in CT. Robert, Raven and Kennerly gowned. Coltrane plays softly. Inside the pericardium, the heart beats against a small, blackened lump of lead embedded in its right ventricular wall, surrounded by angry red tissue.

ROBERT
(calm)
There it is. (beat) Thirty-eight caliber. (beat) Christmas Eve, 1988. (beat) Eighteen years in the dark, and it finally decided to come into the light.

RAVEN
(beat)
The wall around it's paper-thin. (beat) If we pull it straight out, it'll tear.

ROBERT
(beat)
Then we don't pull it straight out. (beat) Pledgeted mattress sutures. (beat) Around it, in a circle, before we touch it. (beat) Like a purse string. (beat) Then we remove the bullet and tie down in one motion. (beat) Dr. Ellison. (beat) Place the first suture.

Raven looks at him over her mask. Robert holds her gaze.

ROBERT
(beat)
You hung his drips for ninety-four days, Dr. Ellison. (beat) Duvall's. (beat) You know what a right ventricle can and can't take. (beat) First suture.

Raven takes the needle driver. She places a felt-pledgeted suture in the beating muscle beside the bullet. Then another. Then four more, in a ring around it. Her hands don't shake.

KENNERLY
(beat, low, watching her hands)
Damn, Ellison.

ROBERT
(beat)
Dr. Kennerly, language. (beat) Dr. Ellison, when I lift it out, you tie down. (beat) Fast. (beat) On three. (beat) One. Two. Three.

Robert lifts the bullet out of the heart with a pair of forceps. Dark blood wells up. Raven cinches the purse string, and the hole closes. The bleeding stops. Robert drops the bullet into a metal basin. Clink.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
Eighteen years. (beat) And all it needed was somebody to stop leaving it alone.

12 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - LIVING ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 9:48 AM

Tuck screams in the playpen. Amond, in his pressed shirt, now with a wet patch on the shoulder, holds a warmed bottle in one hand and Elxa's six pages in the other, reading frantically.

AMOND
(reading aloud)
"If he won't take the bottle, try the other nipple. (beat) The green one." (beat) There's a green one?

He rummages in the diaper bag. He finds a green nipple. He screws it on with surgical precision. He picks up Tuck, holds him against his chest like the instructions say, and offers the bottle. Tuck refuses. Screams harder.

AMOND
(beat, desperate)
I have a Harvard medical degree. (beat) I have a first-author paper in transplant immunology. (beat) I put in an LVAD. (beat) Why won't you eat?

Tuck screams. Amond looks around the room. He sees the stereo. A Coltrane CD case beside it. He walks over, still holding the baby, and presses play. "My Favorite Things" fills the room. Tuck stops screaming mid-breath. He blinks. He looks at the speaker. Then he takes the bottle and begins to drink.

Amond stands in the middle of Elxa Bullock's living room holding a five-week-old baby, listening to John Coltrane, utterly astonished.

AMOND
(beat, whispering)
Your granddaddy plays this in the OR. (beat) Every case. (beat) I hate it. (beat) Don't tell him I said that.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 8 - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 10:06 AM

Toni Graham's wrist is in a temporary splint. Vaughn has finally gone to move his car before it's towed. Harmony sits on the stool beside the gurney. Celia Montague (39) stands just outside the curtain, waiting.

HARMONY
(quietly)
Mrs. Graham. (beat) He's gone for about ten minutes. (beat) The tow trucks on Jackson Avenue are very fast. (beat) Can I ask you something?

TONI
(beat, staring at the wall)
I fell.

HARMONY
(beat)
The bruises on your arm are fingerprints. (beat) Four of them. (beat) Oval. (beat) In a row. (beat) The bruise on your cheek is a week old and the wrist is from today. (beat) You're wearing concealer on your neck too.

Toni's hand moves to her neck. She pulls the cardigan collar up.

TONI
(beat, barely)
You don't know anything about me.

HARMONY
(beat)
No, ma'am. (beat) But my mother serves lunch in a school cafeteria. (beat) For twenty years, she's watched girls come through her line in long sleeves in June. (beat) She taught me to look at sleeves.

A long beat. Toni's eyes fill. She doesn't cry.

TONI
(beat, very quietly)
I'm a secretary at P.S. 40. (beat) Fourteen years. (beat) Everybody likes me. (beat) The kids bring me apples. (beat) If I tell anybody, they'll know. (beat) They'll all know.

HARMONY
(beat)
Know what?

TONI
(beat, barely)
That the nice lady in the front office goes home every night and gets hit.

Harmony reaches over and lays her hand on the splinted wrist, very gently.

HARMONY
(beat)
Mrs. Graham. (beat) There's a woman outside this curtain named Celia Montague. (beat) She does this every day. (beat) She knows places he can't find you. (beat) Will you talk to her? (beat) Just talk.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PROGRAM DIRECTOR'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 10:22 AM

Dr. Eugene Pratt (57) behind his desk. Elxa in her suit, on the edge of the chair, a breast pump bag at her feet that she hopes he doesn't notice. He notices.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Your third-year evaluation. (beat) Four hundred and nineteen cases. (beat) Technical scores in the ninety-sixth percentile nationally on the in-service exam. (beat) Nurses' evaluations: "terrifying," "fair," "best in the building." (beat) The same nurse wrote all three.

ELXA
(beat)
Gloria Pettiford.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Gloria Pettiford. (beat) And then there's this. (beat) Running a surgical board from a desk chair during a nurses' strike at thirty-eight weeks. (beat) Labor in a stairwell during a bomb lockdown. (beat) And eleven pages of instructions for Dr. Okoye that he tells me he has laminated.

He sets down the folder.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) I'd like to name you administrative chief resident for the 2007-08 academic year. (beat) A year early. (beat) It's never been done at Queens Grace.

Elxa stares at him.

ELXA
(beat, carefully)
Dr. Pratt. (beat) My mother is the Chief of Surgery. (beat) After the Joint Commission...

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Your mother recused herself from your file on November ninth. (beat) In writing. (beat) She's never seen this evaluation. (beat) She doesn't know about this meeting. (beat) I wrote this recommendation myself. (beat) Dr. Lowery and Dr. Graves cosigned it. (beat) It's yours on your own merits, Dr. Bullock. (beat) Every case of it.

Elxa looks at the folder for a long beat. Then she reaches down, picks up the breast pump bag and sets it defiantly on her lap.

ELXA
(beat)
I accept. (beat) Now, Dr. Pratt, is there somewhere private I can use this before my son's babysitter has a nervous breakdown?

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PLASTIC SURGERY SUITE - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 10:41 AM

Esther walks down the Plastics corridor with a consult. Malcolm, his nose healed now, only a faint bump on the bridge, comes out of his office with a coffee. They stop. It's become a kind of habit, these hallway stops.

ESTHER
(beat)
Clayton said you had lunch. (beat) A week ago Thursday. (beat) At Monty's.

MALCOLM
(beat)
We did.

ESTHER
(beat)
What did you talk about?

MALCOLM
(beat)
The Red Sox for forty minutes. (beat) Then you for five. (beat) Then the Red Sox again. (beat) He paid. (beat) He insisted. (beat) He said it was "his turn to be magnanimous."

ESTHER
(beat, almost smiling)
That sounds like Clayton.

MALCOLM
(beat)
He's a good man, Est. (beat) Better than me. (beat) He always was. (beat) That was always the worst part.

A long beat. Esther looks at him.

ESTHER
(beat)
What did he say? (beat) The five minutes. (beat) About me.

Malcolm takes a breath.

MALCOLM
(beat, carefully)
He said he's been trying to love you enough to make up for Boston. (beat) And that some days he thinks it's working. (beat) And some days he thinks you're both just holding very still so nothing moves.

Esther goes pale.

MALCOLM
(beat)
I shouldn't have told you. (beat) That was his to tell.

ESTHER
(beat, barely)
No. (beat) It's fine. (beat) No more Octobers. (beat) It's fine.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 3 - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:03 AM

Dash, day 122 since his first admission, afebrile now, the driveline site clean, the pump humming. He sits in the chair by the window in his Carolina blue hoodie, doing arm curls with a pair of two-pound weights the physical therapist left. Glenda is at her sublet. Raven comes in, still in her OR cap, glowing.

DASH
(beat)
You look like you just did something.

RAVEN
(beat)
I sewed a purse string around a bullet in a man's right ventricle. (beat) Your Dr. Bullock let me tie it down.

DASH
(beat, grinning)
In a beating heart?

RAVEN
(beat)
In a beating heart.

DASH
(beat)
Then you can do mine.

RAVEN
(beat, laughing)
I'm an intern, Dash.

DASH
(beat)
You're my intern. (beat) Dr. Bullock can watch.

He sets down the weights. His smile fades a little.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
Raven. (beat) Problem came by last night. (beat) With crackers. (beat) She sat with me for an hour while you were in the ER. (beat) We watched a Panthers highlight show and she told me she thinks the Panthers are "a waste of a perfectly good animal." (beat) I like her.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
I know you do.

DASH
(beat)
That's the problem, isn't it?

RAVEN
(beat)
That's the problem.

DASH
(beat)
I'm not going to ask you to choose, Raven. (beat) Not while I've got a pump in my belly. (beat) Not while you could be choosing a funeral. (beat) When I've got a heart, (beat) then I'll ask.

RAVEN
(beat, fierce)
Then get a heart.

DASH
(beat, picking up the weights again)
I'm doing curls, aren't I?

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:19 AM

Harmony comes out of the curtain of Bay 8, where Toni sits talking quietly with Celia. Vaughn Graham comes fast down the corridor from the ambulance entrance, his car keys in his hand, his jaw tight. He sees the social worker's lanyard through the gap in the curtain. He stops in front of Harmony.

VAUGHN
(beat, low)
Who's that in there with my wife?

HARMONY
(beat, steady)
A member of our staff, Mr. Graham. (beat) Your wife's being cared for.

VAUGHN
(beat)
I want to see her.

HARMONY
(beat)
Not right now.

Vaughn grabs Harmony's upper arm. Hard. Four fingers and a thumb, exactly where the bruises are on his wife's arm.

VAUGHN
(beat, very quietly)
Get out of my way, Doctor.

Harmony looks down at his hand on her arm. She doesn't pull away. She looks back up at him, and her voice gets very calm and very loud, the voice she uses in church.

HARMONY
(beat, loudly)
Mr. Graham, you're hurting my arm. (beat) Please take your hand off me.

Every head in the ER turns. Gloria, at the nurses' station, picks up the phone. Marc comes around the corner from Trauma 2 and sees Vaughn's hand on Harmony's arm.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:20 AM

Marc reaches them in four strides. He doesn't touch Vaughn. He stands very close, at his full height.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
Let go of her, sir.

Vaughn looks at Marc. At Harmony. At the faces turned toward them up and down the ER. He lets go. Big Ray comes through the double doors with two security guards behind him. He takes in the scene in one glance.

BIG RAY
(beat, calm)
Mr. Graham. (beat) I'm going to need you to come with me.

VAUGHN
(beat)
I didn't do anything.

BIG RAY
(beat)
You put your hand on one of our doctors in front of nine witnesses. (beat) And a camera. (beat) That one. (beat) Over the nurses' station. (beat) Come with me, sir.

Vaughn looks up at the camera. His face changes. He goes with Big Ray. At the end of the corridor, he looks back at the curtain of Bay 8. Toni, inside, has heard everything through the curtain. She sits frozen, with Celia's hand on her shoulder.

MARC
(beat, to Harmony)
Are you okay?

HARMONY
(beat, rubbing her arm, shaking now)
He grabbed me exactly where he grabs her. (beat) Exactly there. (beat) Four fingers. (beat) He's done it so many times it's just where his hand goes.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - CAST ROOM - DAY

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:46 AM

Camille (29) sits Harmony down on a stool and examines her arm with the gentleness of someone who breaks bones for a living. Four faint red marks are rising on the upper arm.

CAMILLE
(beat, low, furious)
I'm going to find that man in the security office and break all twenty-seven bones in his hand.

HARMONY
(beat)
You're an orthopedic surgeon, Camille. (beat) You fix bones.

CAMILLE
(beat)
I know which ones not to fix, Choir.

Harmony laughs, shakily. Camille presses an ice pack to the arm.

HARMONY
(beat)
Two weeks ago. (beat) Mardi Gras. (beat) Your father. (beat) He stood up at the end of dinner. (beat) He said what he said. (beat) And I've been thinking about it ever since.

CAMILLE
(beat, quietly)
"I cannot bless it, Camille. (beat) I am sixty-five years old and a Catholic and a man from the Seventh Ward. (beat) I cannot bless it. (beat) But I will not lose you over it. (beat) And the girl is welcome at my table."

HARMONY
(beat)
That's not acceptance.

CAMILLE
(beat)
No. (beat) It's not. (beat) It's more than I ever thought he'd say. (beat) And less than I want. (beat) It's a bandage, Choir. (beat) Over a hole he doesn't know how to close.

HARMONY
(beat, looking at the marks on her arm)
Toni Graham's been wearing bandages for six years. (beat) Concealer. Long sleeves. "I fell." (beat) I don't want us to live under one.

Camille sets down the ice pack. She looks at Harmony for a long moment.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Then we won't. (beat) We'll go to his table. (beat) And we'll be exactly what we are. (beat) And one day, he'll either take the bandage off or he won't. (beat) That's his to do. (beat) Not ours.

20 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - NURSERY - DAY

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:58 AM

Disaster. A changing table. A diaper, half on. Wipes everywhere. A stain on Amond's pressed shirt that is not formula. Tuck, naked from the waist down, kicks happily. Amond stands over him with a fresh diaper, his cell phone wedged between his ear and his shoulder.

AMOND
(into the phone, desperate)
Mrs. Divine. (beat) It's Amond Baker. (beat) Harmony's housemate. (beat) I'm sorry to call you at school. (beat) Harmony gave me your number in case of emergency. (beat) This is an emergency.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
(on the phone, delighted)
Amond, baby! (beat) Are you with Elxa's little one?

AMOND
(beat)
I'm with Elxa's little one, ma'am. (beat) He has... (beat) There was an event. (beat) An explosive event.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
(laughing)
Oh, baby. (beat) Did you get it on you?

AMOND
(beat, looking down at his shirt)
On me. (beat) On the wall. (beat) On page four of the instructions.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
(beat, calm)
All right. (beat) Listen to me. (beat) Front to back. (beat) Tabs in the back. (beat) Fold the front up, pull the tabs around, stick them down. (beat) Not too tight. (beat) Two fingers' room. (beat) Like a blood pressure cuff.

Amond does it. Front to back. Tabs. Two fingers. He steps back and looks at it. It's perfect.

AMOND
(beat, staring)
It worked.

LILLIAN (V.O.)
(beat)
Of course it worked, baby. (beat) You're a surgeon. (beat) A diaper's just a dressing with tabs.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 7 - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 12:14 PM

Harlan Moody, post-op, intubated, chest tubes in, his heart beating steadily on the monitor. His wife Geneva sits beside him. On the tray table, in a small plastic specimen cup with a lid, sits a blackened, misshapen .38 caliber bullet. Robert and Raven stand at the bedside.

GENEVA
(beat, picking up the cup and turning it in the light)
Eighteen years. (beat) Christmas Eve, 1988. (beat) I was pregnant with our daughter. (beat) The surgeons came out and said, "We left it in. It's safer." (beat) We had a party when he came home. (beat) A party. (beat) And it was in him the whole time.

ROBERT
(beat, gently)
In 1988, Mrs. Moody, it was safer. (beat) They made the right call. (beat) But a bullet in the body is never really still. (beat) It just moves too slowly for anyone to notice.

GENEVA
(beat)
Can he keep it? (beat) The bullet?

ROBERT
(beat)
The police will want to log it. (beat) Then I'll make sure it comes back to him.

GENEVA
(beat, setting the cup down, looking at Raven)
You're the one who sewed the circle. (beat) Dr. Bullock told me. (beat) Around it.

RAVEN
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

GENEVA
(beat)
Thank you for not leaving it alone, baby. (beat) Everybody else did.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 12:31 PM

The lunch rush. Miss Hattie (61) at the register. At a table in the very center of the cafeteria, in front of everybody: Kennerly, in Gloria's tie, and Kendra Wallace, in her scrubs, eating Miss Hattie's meatloaf. Doctors and nurses at nearby tables are not even pretending not to

watch. Marc and Arianna sit at the next table.

KENDRA
(beat)
Everybody's staring at us.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I know. (beat) That was the point. (beat) In September, I sat at that table over there and told this whole room something that wasn't mine to tell. (beat) Today I'm sitting at this table telling this whole room something that is.

Kendra looks at him. Then she puts down her fork, leans across the table and kisses him, quickly, in front of the whole cafeteria. A cheer goes up from the nurses' table. Miss Hattie, at the register, shakes her head and smiles.

ARIANNA
(beat, deadpan, to Marc)
That's going on the blog in four minutes.

MARC
(beat)
Three.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 8 - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 12:58 PM

Toni Graham, her wrist now in a proper cast, sits on the gurney with her coat in her lap. Celia stands beside her with a folder. Harmony comes in. Toni looks up at her.

TONI
(beat, barely)
He grabbed you. (beat) The way he grabs me. (beat) I heard it through the curtain. (beat) In front of everybody. (beat) And you said it out loud. (beat) "You're hurting my arm." (beat) Just like that.

HARMONY
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

TONI
(beat)
I've never said it out loud. (beat) Not once. (beat) Six years.

A long silence.

CELIA
(gently)
Mrs. Graham has a sister in Westchester he's never met. (beat) And Safe Horizon has a bed tonight if she wants one. (beat) And the police are waiting in the family room if she wants to talk to them.

TONI
(beat, looking at Harmony)
If I go to the police, (beat) will you come with me?

HARMONY
(beat)
If you want me there.

TONI
(beat, standing up slowly, holding her cast against her chest)
Then I'm going to go say it out loud. (beat) One time. (beat) To see what it sounds like.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

24 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - LIVING ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 1:07 PM

The front door opens quietly. Elxa comes in, an hour late, in her suit, out of breath, braced for disaster. She stops. Coltrane's "My Favorite Things" plays softly on repeat. On the sofa, Amond Baker lies flat on his back, fast asleep in a stained shirt, one arm curled protectively over Tuck, who sleeps face down on his chest, rising and falling with Amond's breathing. Elxa's six-page instructions have slipped to the floor. On top of them lies an open cardiology journal turned to an illustration of the heart.

Elxa stands in the doorway for a long moment. Then she quietly takes a disposable camera from the drawer of the side table, raises it, and takes a picture. Click. Neither of them wakes.

ELXA
(whispering, to herself)
Fell asleep at the tricuspid valve. (beat) Every time.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - FAMILY ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 1:22 PM

The small room with the painting of a lake. Toni Graham sits on the sofa with her cast in her lap. A female NYPD detective from the 103rd Precinct, DETECTIVE ROCHELLE AMES (41), sits across from her with a notebook. Harmony sits beside Toni. Celia stands by the door.

DETECTIVE AMES
(gently)
Mrs. Graham. (beat) Whenever you're ready. (beat) In your own words.

A long silence. Toni looks at Harmony. Harmony nods.

TONI
(beat, barely)
My husband hits me. (beat) Vaughn Graham. (beat) He's been hitting me since 2000. (beat) Six years. (beat) Today he twisted my wrist until it broke because I burned his toast. (beat) My husband hits me.

She stops. She stares at the wall. The words are in the room now, and they can't be put back.

TONI
(beat, almost wondering)
That's what it sounds like.

DETECTIVE AMES
(beat, softly)
Yes, ma'am. (beat) That's what it sounds like.

TONI
(beat, starting to cry for the first time)
I thought it would be louder.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - NURSES' STATION - DAY

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 2:04 PM

Robert writes post-op orders on Harlan Moody. Amond comes up beside him, back in clean scrubs, his hair still damp, smelling faintly of baby wipes. Robert glances at him.

ROBERT
(beat, not looking up)
You babysat my grandson.

AMOND
(beat)
Three and a half hours, sir. (beat) And forty minutes of sleep before that. (beat) I'm here because I can't sleep in a house that smells like formula.

ROBERT
(beat)
How was he?

AMOND
(beat, dry)
He refused the bottle until I played Coltrane. (beat) Then he had what your daughter's instructions call "an event." (beat) Then I called Harmony Divine's mother at P.S. 118 for diaper instructions. (beat) Then I read him the anatomy of the heart and we both fell asleep at the tricuspid valve.

Robert stops writing. He looks at Amond. Then he laughs, a real, startled laugh, the first in weeks.

ROBERT
(beat)
Coltrane.

AMOND
(beat)
He loves it. (beat) I'm sorry to tell you I don't, sir. (beat) I've never told you that in eight months.

ROBERT
(beat, still smiling)
I know you don't, Dr. Baker. (beat) You clench your jaw every time "My Favorite Things" comes on. (beat) I've been playing it at you on purpose since August.

Amond stares at him.

ROBERT
(beat, going back to his orders)
It builds character. (beat) Ask my daughter.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - GYNECOLOGY RECOVERY - DAY
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 2:37 PM

Natasha, in scrubs, writes post-op orders for her hysterectomy patient at the counter. Elxa comes in with Tuck in his carrier and Amond's stained shirt in a plastic bag. She sets the carrier on the counter.

ELXA
(beat)
Mama. (beat) I had my evaluation with Dr. Pratt this morning.

NATASHA
(beat, not looking up)
I recused myself from your file in November, baby. (beat) I'm not allowed to ask.

ELXA
(beat)
I know. (beat) That's why I'm telling you. (beat) He named me administrative chief resident. (beat) For 2007. (beat) A year early. (beat) Lowery and Graves cosigned it.

Natasha's pen stops. She looks up at her daughter.

ELXA
(beat)
You didn't know. (beat) You really didn't know. (beat) I could see it on your face just now. (beat) You didn't know.

NATASHA
(beat, very quietly)
I didn't know.

ELXA
(beat, her voice catching)
Then it's mine. (beat) All of it. (beat) Nobody can ever say a Donohue handed it to me.

Natasha comes around the counter and takes her daughter's face in both hands.

NATASHA
(beat)
Nobody ever handed you anything, Elxa. (beat) You took it. (beat) The way you took a stairwell.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MAIN LOBBY - DUSK
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 4:52 PM

The lobby at the end of the day shift. Late-afternoon light through the revolving door. Esther comes out of the elevator with her coat on. She stops. Through the big glass front windows: a red Vespa pulled up at the curb on Jackson Avenue. Faith Danforth, in a peacoat and a helmet, sits on it with a second helmet in her hand and Mercy in a dog carrier strapped to the back.

Marc comes out of the revolving door into the cold, laughing at something. Faith takes off her helmet, says something, and Marc laughs again, the kind of laugh Esther hasn't heard from him in months. Faith hands him the second helmet. He puts it on. It's too small. She fixes

the strap for him, reaching up, her hands under his chin.

Esther stands inside the lobby behind the glass and watches. Big Ray, at the security desk, watches Esther watching.

The Vespa pulls away from the curb with Marc on the back, holding on to Faith's waist, Mercy's head poking out of the carrier. It turns onto Vernon Boulevard and is gone.

BIG RAY
(beat, quietly, from the desk)
He's humming, Dr. Smilley. (beat) All week. (beat) Stevie Wonder.

ESTHER
(beat, not turning around)
I know, Ray.

29 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:04 PM

Clayton stands at the stove in the galley kitchen, cooking. Esther comes in. She doesn't take off her coat. She doesn't put down her bag. She stands in the middle of the living room.

CLAYTON
(beat, turning)
Hey. (beat) I made...

ESTHER
(beat, quietly)
Clayton. (beat) We're a bandage.

Clayton turns off the stove.

ESTHER
(beat)
Over a bullet hole. (beat) That's what we are. (beat) Eight months of No More Octobers. (beat) Therapy on Thursdays. (beat) One box, then two boxes, then my coat on your hook. (beat) It's a very good bandage. (beat) It's the best bandage anybody ever made. (beat) And the bullet is still in there.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

30 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:05 PM

Clayton stands very still by the stove.

CLAYTON
(beat, carefully)
Malcolm told you. (beat) About lunch. (beat) What I said.

ESTHER
(beat)
He told me you said we're both holding very still so nothing moves. (beat) He thought he shouldn't have told me. (beat) He was right that he shouldn't have. (beat) But you were right to say it.

She finally sets down her bag.

ESTHER
(beat)
Today a retired cop had a bullet taken out of his heart. (beat) They left it in for eighteen years because it was "safer." (beat) And it moved, Clayton. (beat) Slowly. (beat) A little every day. (beat) Until one morning it tried to go through the wall. (beat) And a woman with a broken wrist said "My husband hits me" out loud for the first time in six years, and she said it sounded quieter than she expected. (beat) And I stood in the lobby and watched Marc ride away on a Vespa, and I felt like somebody had pulled a bandage off me without asking.

CLAYTON
(beat, barely)
Are you leaving me?

ESTHER
(beat)
No. (beat) I don't know. (beat) Not tonight. (beat) I'm telling you I'm tired of holding still. (beat) I don't want a bandage anymore. (beat) I want to open it. (beat) Even if it bleeds. (beat) Even if what we find in there is the end of us.

A long silence. Clayton crosses the room and stands in front of her.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
Then let's open it. (beat) Properly. (beat) Not just Thursdays. (beat) Not just "no more Octobers." (beat) All of it. (beat) Boston. (beat) Malcolm. (beat) Marc. (beat) What you feel when he laughs. (beat) What I feel when Malcolm walks into a room. (beat) Everything.

ESTHER
(beat, her eyes filling)
And if it's the end of us?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Then at least it'll be a real end, Esther. (beat) Not a bandage that finally fell off in the shower.

31 INT. DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE'S OFFICE - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 6:33 PM

Session three. Natasha and Robert on the sofa, a little closer than two weeks ago. Not touching. On the coffee table between them and Dr. Greenidge lies a small, yellowed envelope: "Robert Bullock -- Personal." Sealed.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
Natasha. (beat) You asked Robert to bring it tonight.

NATASHA
(beat)
I said I'd open it when I could stand in the same room with it. (beat) I'm in the same room with it. (beat) That's all I can do tonight.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
Robert. (beat) How does it feel, seeing it here?

ROBERT
(beat, staring at it)
Like the bullet we took out of a man's heart this morning. (beat) It was in a basin on the back table. (beat) Out of him. (beat) Not gone. (beat) Just out where everybody could see it.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
Do either of you want to open it?

A long, long silence. Natasha and Robert look at the envelope. Then at each other.

NATASHA
(beat, finally)
No. (beat) Not yet. (beat) Not because I'm afraid of what's in it. (beat) Because I'm afraid of what I'd do with it this month. (beat) I want to be strong enough to read it and still be sober. (beat) I'm not there yet.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
Then we'll wait until you are.

NATASHA
(beat)
We'll put it somewhere neither of us can get to it on a bad night. (beat) Franklin has a safe.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat, nodding slowly)
That's a very wise decision, Natasha. (beat) Knowing when to open something is as important as opening it.

32 INT. FAITH DANFORTH'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE CLINIC - ASTORIA - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 7:08 PM

A small, warm, slightly chaotic apartment above the animal hospital. Books on veterinary pharmacology. Mismatched furniture. A pot of chili on the stove. On a dog bed by the radiator, a gray three-legged greyhound, RUTH BADER GINSBURG, lies curled up beside Mercy, the two dogs touching noses. Faith sets two bowls on a small table by the window. Marc sits across from her. The N train rattles by outside the window.

FAITH
(beat)
Ruth was a racer in Florida. (beat) She broke her leg at a track in Palm Beach. (beat) They were going to put her down. (beat) I drove eleven hundred miles to get her. (beat) Three legs. (beat) She's the fastest thing in Astoria.

MARC
(beat, smiling)
You drove to Florida for a dog.

FAITH
(beat)
I drive everywhere for dogs. (beat) It's a character flaw. (beat) People are harder. (beat) I don't know how to drive to people.

A beat. Faith looks at the faint pink scar over his eyebrow.

FAITH
(beat)
You don't have to tell me about it. (beat) The scar. (beat) The thing everybody in Queens knows. (beat) I just want you to know that if you ever want to, I'm good at sitting still. (beat) Vets have to be. (beat) Animals can't tell you where it hurts.

Marc looks at her for a long time.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
When there's a loud noise, everything goes white. (beat) For a second. (beat) That's all. (beat) I'm working on it. (beat) Mondays at four. (beat) A man in a bow tie.

FAITH
(beat, simply)
Okay.

MARC
(beat)
That's it? (beat) "Okay"?

FAITH
(beat, picking up her spoon)
You told me where it hurts. (beat) That's more than Ruth ever did. (beat) Eat your chili, Marc.

He laughs. They eat. On the dog bed, Mercy puts her head on the greyhound's back and sighs. Later, at the door, with the N train going by below, Faith kisses him, simply and without hesitation, the way she does everything.

33 INT. SAFE HORIZON SHELTER - UNDISCLOSED LOCATION, QUEENS - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 8:02 PM

A plain, clean lobby with a buzzer door and a cheerful mural of sunflowers. A night manager behind a desk. Toni Graham sits on a bench with a garbage bag of clothes and her cast. Harmony sits beside her. Toni holds a borrowed cell phone to her ear.

TONI
(into the phone, crying)
Denise. (beat) Neecie, it's me. (beat) I'm okay. (beat) I'm not okay. (beat) I'm somewhere safe. (beat) Vaughn did something. (beat) He's been doing something. (beat) For six years. (beat) Can I... (beat) Can I come to you this weekend? (beat) In Mount Vernon? (beat) Just for a while?

She listens. She covers her mouth. She nods even though her sister can't see her.

TONI
(barely)
Thank you. (beat) Thank you. (beat) I love you too.

She hangs up. She sits with the phone in her lap. Harmony doesn't say anything.

TONI
(beat, looking at Harmony)
You can go home now, Dr. Divine. (beat) It's late.

HARMONY
(beat)
I'll go when you're upstairs.

TONI
(beat, almost smiling)
Your mother taught you that? (beat) Watching sleeves in the lunch line?

HARMONY
(beat)
My mother taught me you don't leave somebody on a bench.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 3 - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 8:41 PM

Dash in the chair by the window. Raven on the edge of the bed. Arianna, in her coat, in the visitor's chair, with a takeout bag. Glenda comes in with a foil-covered dish.

GLENDA
(beat)
Pound cake. (beat) My mother's recipe. (beat) For all three of you. (beat) Since apparently it's all three of you now.

A beat. Raven goes red. Arianna doesn't blink. Dash grins.

DASH
(beat)
Mama.

GLENDA
(beat, cutting slices with a plastic knife)
Darius, I've been watching this room for four months. (beat) I'm fifty-eight years old. (beat) I wasn't born yesterday, and I wasn't born in Charlotte, I was born in Harlem. (beat) Eat the cake.

She hands slices around. Arianna takes hers and studies Glenda Duvall.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Mrs. Duvall. (beat) You're not mad at me?

GLENDA
(beat, sitting down with her knitting)
Baby, I'm mad at that heart in his chest for being so slow. (beat) I'm mad at the pump for getting infected. (beat) I'm mad at the list. (beat) I don't have any mad left over for a girl who brings my son crackers.

35 INT. THE DIVINE HOUSE - CAMBRIA HEIGHTS - KITCHEN - NIGHT

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 9:07 PM

Lillian at the sink. Howard at the table with a plate of leftovers and his reading glasses, the Daily News open to the Gordon Parks obituary.

LILLIAN
(beat, laughing)
He called me at P.S. 118. (beat) In the middle of second lunch. (beat) "Mrs. Divine, there was an explosive event." (beat) Harmony's roommate. (beat) The serious one. (beat) The Harvard one.

HOWARD
(beat, grinning)
What did you tell him?

LILLIAN
(beat)
I told him a diaper's just a dressing with tabs. (beat) He said, "It worked." (beat) Like he'd discovered penicillin.

Howard laughs. The laugh turns into a cough, deep and wet. It goes on longer than usual. Lillian turns from the sink. He waves her off and takes a sip of water.

HOWARD
(beat)
June, Lil. (beat) The CT's in June. (beat) Don't look at me like that.

LILLIAN
(beat, quietly, drying her hands)
I'm going to look at you like that until June, Howard Divine. (beat) And then I'm going to look at you like that some more.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - GENERAL COUNSEL'S OFFICE - NIGHT

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 9:41 PM

Bassett's cluttered office. Bassett, called in late, in a sweater, kneels in front of a heavy steel safe in the corner and spins the dial. Natasha and Robert stand behind him. Robert holds the yellowed envelope. Bassett swings open the safe door. On the top shelf: a single manila envelope sealed with red tape. Kennerly's sworn statement.

BASSETT
(beat)
You're sure.

NATASHA
(beat)
We're sure, Franklin. (beat) Neither of us can open it without the other one. (beat) And without you.

Robert sets the small, yellowed envelope on the shelf beside the manila one. Bassett looks at the two envelopes side by side.

BASSETT
(beat, dry)
This safe is getting very crowded with other people's secrets, Natasha.

NATASHA
(beat)
That's what it's for, Franklin.
(beat) Somewhere for the things
that aren't ready.

Bassett closes the safe and spins the dial. Robert and Natasha stand side by side in front of it. After a moment, Natasha's hand finds Robert's. Just for a second. Then she lets go.

37 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 10:06 PM

The bar. Kennerly, his tie loosened, and Kendra sit at the bar. Monty slides over a laptop open to QueensGraceConfidential: "THE CAFETERIA KISS: DR. K & NURSE W GO PUBLIC (FINALLY)." Posted 12:34 PM.

KENDRA
(beat, reading it)
Three minutes after. (beat)
Bullock was right.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Cummings said four.

MONTY
(beat)
You want to know who writes it?
(beat) The blog?

KENNERLY AND KENDRA
(together)
Yes.

MONTY
(beat, closing the
laptop, smiling)
I'm a vault, Doctor.

KENNERLY
(beat)
With a tap.

MONTY
(beat, pouring)
Not for that one. (beat) That one I take to my grave.

38 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - KITCHEN - NIGHT

MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 10:33 PM

The kitchen, quiet. Russell, without his helmet for a moment, sits at the table. Elxa nurses Tuck in the rocking chair Robert built in 1977, the one with the leftover screw. On the refrigerator, held by a magnet: a Polaroid-style print from the one-hour photo place on Linden Boulevard. Amond Baker asleep on the sofa with Tuck on his chest.

RUSSELL
(beat, looking at the photo)
Amond Baker.

ELXA
(beat, smiling)
Amond Baker. (beat) Read him to sleep at the tricuspid valve.

RUSSELL
(beat)
And you? (beat) Pratt?

ELXA
(beat)
Administrative chief resident. (beat) 2007. (beat) A year early. (beat) Mama didn't know. (beat) I watched her face. (beat) She really didn't know.

Russell gets up slowly and comes over to the rocking chair. He kneels beside it with some difficulty and puts his hand on his son's back.

RUSSELL
(beat)
I'm going to have my skull put back next Monday. (beat) My wife's going to be chief resident. (beat) And my son likes Coltrane. (beat) That's a good week, Elxa.

ELXA
(beat, softly)
That's a good week.

TAG

39 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:36 PM

Amond sits at the kitchen table with a cup of tea. The front door opens. Marc comes in with Mercy, his cheeks red from the cold, a too-small Vespa helmet under his arm. They look at each other.

AMOND
(beat)
I changed a diaper.

MARC
(beat)
I had a second date.

A beat. Then both of them start to laugh. Mercy barks.

AMOND
(beat)
Tabs in the back. (beat) Two fingers' room. (beat) Like a blood pressure cuff.

MARC
(beat)
She has a three-legged greyhound named Ruth Bader Ginsburg.

AMOND
(beat, deadpan)
Of course she does.

40 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
MONDAY, MARCH 13, 2006 - 11:58 PM

Marc sits on the stoop with Mercy beside him. Spring is coming: the snow is gone, and the trees on 49th Avenue show the first faint red of buds. Across the river, Manhattan. He takes Victor's gold watch out of his pocket and opens it. "SPEND IT RIGHT."

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you in surgery that you can't put a bandage on a bullet hole.

In a safe in the General Counsel's office, two sealed envelopes sit side by side in the dark.

MARC (V.O.)
But they don't teach you that a bullet doesn't stay where you left it. (beat) It moves. (beat) Slowly. (beat) For years. (beat) Until one day it reaches the wall.

In a shelter in Queens, Toni Graham sleeps in a narrow bed with her cast on her chest.

MARC (V.O.)
Some of us take it out on the table, in front of everybody. (beat) Some of us lock it in a safe until we're strong enough to look.

In Brooklyn Heights, Esther and Clayton sit at opposite ends of the sofa, talking, the lamp still on at midnight.

MARC (V.O.)
And some of us finally just say it out loud. (beat) To a detective. (beat) To a husband. (beat) To a vet with a three-legged dog. (beat) And find out it's quieter than we thought.

Marc closes the watch. He puts it in his pocket.

MARC (V.O.)
That's not healing. (beat) Not yet. (beat) But it's the first honest cut.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x20

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "GORDON PARKS, 93, DIES; PHOTOGRAPHER, FILMMAKER, PIONEER"

March 8, 2006

"Gordon Parks, the photographer, filmmaker and composer who chronicled Black American life for Life magazine and directed 'Shaft,' died Tuesday at his home in Manhattan. He was 93..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "MILOSEVIC FOUND DEAD IN HIS CELL"

Saturday, March 11, 2006

"THE HAGUE, Netherlands (AP) -- Slobodan Milosevic, the former Yugoslav president on trial for war crimes, was found dead in his prison cell..." Also from the week: the Dubai Ports World deal collapsed March 9, and on March 5 'Crash' won Best Picture and Three 6 Mafia won Best Original Song.

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, March 13, 2006, 12:34 PM

"THE CAFETERIA KISS: DR. K & NURSE W GO PUBLIC (FINALLY). At 12:31 PM, at the CENTER TABLE, in the TIE. In September he told this cafeteria something that wasn't his. Today he told it something that was. Character development, people. Also: an intern sewed a purse string around a BULLET in a BEATING HEART this morning. And a certain post-call intern is reportedly babysitting a certain five-week-old in St. Albans. We hope he's okay. We hope the baby's okay. We're mostly worried about the intern." Comments (3,904).

Photograph on Elxa and Russell's refrigerator (one-hour print, Linden Boulevard)

Taken Monday, March 13, 2006, 1:07 PM

Dr. Amond Baker asleep on the sofa in a stained shirt, Tuck asleep face down on his chest, a cardiology journal open to the heart on the floor. Elxa wrote on the border: "TRICUSPID VALVE. EVERY TIME."

Contents of the General Counsel's safe (per Bassett)

As of March 13, 2006, 9:41 PM

1) A manila envelope, red tape: the sworn statement of Dr. Bryce Kennerly (December 1, 2005). 2) A small yellowed envelope: 'Robert Bullock -- Personal' (from the Estate of Dr. Delphine A. Ware). Both SEALED. Opening the second requires Robert, Natasha and Bassett together.

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Amond Baker to Marc Bullock)

Monday, March 13, 2006, 11:58 AM

Amond: "explosive event. calling harmonys mother. do not tell your father"

Marc: "already told him"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x20

New Canon Established

- **AMOND BABYSAT TUCK** (counterpart of Cristina babysitting for Bailey) from 8:29 AM to 1:07 PM, post-call after 40 minutes of sleep, with six pages of instructions. Tuck refused the bottle until Amond played Coltrane's 'My Favorite Things.' After 'an explosive event,' Amond called **Lillian Divine** at P.S. 118 ('A diaper's just a dressing with tabs... two fingers' room, like a blood pressure cuff'). He read the heart anatomy, and both fell asleep 'at the tricuspid valve.' **Elxa photographed them**; the print is on her refrigerator. Robert admitted he has played Coltrane at Amond on purpose since August: 'It builds character.'
- **ELXA NAMED 2007-08 ADMINISTRATIVE CHIEF RESIDENT**, a year early and a first at QGH, by Dr. Pratt, cosigned by Lowery and Graves. Natasha had recused herself from Elxa's file on November 9 and **did not know**. Elxa: 'Nobody can ever say a Donohue handed it to me.' Natasha: 'You took it. The way you took a stairwell.' Her record: 419 cases, in-service technical scores in the 96th percentile, and Gloria's evaluations 'terrifying,' 'fair,' 'best in the building.'
- **MARC AND FAITH:** first date Saturday, March 4, at Taverna Kyclades (she ordered in Greek, sent back a corked wine, then a midnight Vespa ride over the Pulaski Bridge and goodnight on the stoop). Since then he's been humming 'Isn't She Lovely.' **Second date March 13** at her apartment above the clinic: chili, and her three-legged ex-racing greyhound **Ruth Bader Ginsburg** (Palm Beach; Faith drove 1,100 miles for her), who bonded with Mercy. Marc told her about the 'white' startle and Mondays with Bynum. Faith: 'You told me where it hurts... Eat your chili.' **First kiss. Esther watched them leave on the Vespa** from the lobby, and Big Ray noticed.
- **ESTHER AND CLAYTON:** at his March 2 lunch with Malcolm (Red Sox for 40 minutes, Esther for 5, Clayton paid), Clayton said he and Esther are 'both just holding very still so nothing moves.' Malcolm told Esther. **Esther: 'We're a bandage. Over a bullet hole.'** She is not leaving 'tonight,' but she wants to open it 'even if it's the end of us.' Clayton: 'Then let's open it. Properly... Boston. Malcolm. Marc... Everything.' **The marriage is in genuine crisis**; it is honest and unresolved.
- **THE SEALED LETTER** was placed on Greenidge's coffee table in session 3 and not opened. Natasha: 'I want to be strong enough to read it and still be sober.' **It now sits in Bassett's safe beside Kennerly's sworn statement**, and opening it requires Robert, Natasha and Bassett together. Natasha briefly took Robert's hand. **Victor and Natasha agreed the heir revelation will come in June 2006**, when the intern year ends. Victor photographed for Life by Gordon Parks in 1968: 'Start smiling like you built it.'
- **Harlan Moody**, a retired NYPD sergeant shot Christmas Eve 1988 with a .38 left in his chest wall at Jamaica Hospital as 'safer,' had the bullet migrate into the RV free wall and erode it, causing tamponade in CT. **Raven placed the pledgeted purse-string sutures and tied down** as Robert lifted it out of the beating heart. Robert: 'All it needed was somebody to stop leaving it alone.' Geneva: 'Thank you for not leaving it alone.' The bullet will be returned to him.
- **Harmony and Toni Graham:** she spotted fingertip bruises ('My mother taught me to look at sleeves'). **Vaughn Graham grabbed Harmony's arm in the ER**; she called it out loudly, Marc

intervened and Big Ray removed him (on camera). Toni gave a statement to Det. Rochelle Ames: 'My husband hits me... I thought it would be louder.' Harmony took her to a Safe Horizon shelter, and she goes to her sister Denise in Mount Vernon this weekend. **Augustin's Mardi Gras words** (February 28): 'I cannot bless it... But I will not lose you over it. And the girl is welcome at my table.' That is tolerance, not acceptance, consistent with MA-005. Camille: 'It's a bandage.'

- **Dash** (day 122, afebrile, driveline healing, doing two-pound curls): 'When I've got a heart, then I'll ask [you to choose].' Arianna brought crackers and watched a Panthers highlight show with him. Glenda (born in Harlem, per this episode) baked pound cake 'for all three of you.' **Kennerly and Kendra kissed publicly in the cafeteria** (third date). Monty knows who writes QueensGraceConfidential and will 'take it to my grave.' Russell's cranioplasty is Monday, March 20. Howard's cough worsened; the June CT stands.

Knowledge Tracker (as of March 13, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Marc and Faith dating	The housemates, Esther, Big Ray, the blog
Esther's 'bandage' talk with Clayton	Esther, Clayton (Malcolm partially)
Elxa chief resident 2007-08	Elxa, Natasha, Russell, Pratt, Lowery, Graves
The sealed letter (in the safe)	Robert, Natasha, Bassett, Dr. Greenidge; contents unknown to all
Heir revelation set for June 2006	Victor, Natasha
Who writes QueensGraceConfidential	Monty (and the author)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Harlan Moody	11/11/1944 (61)	Retained .38 bullet (1988) migrated into the RV free wall; pericardial effusion and tamponade	Emergent pericardiocentesis; sternotomy, pledgeted purse string, bullet removal (R. Bullock; Ellison; Kennerly)	Stable in CVICU
Antoinette 'Toni' Graham	10/17/1971 (34)	Distal radius fracture; IPV injuries (fingertip bruising, facial contusion)	Splint, then cast (Lowery; Divine); social work (Montague)	Statement to NYPD; Safe Horizon
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	LVAD driveline infection, resolving	IV antibiotics	Afebrile; waiting
Hysterectomy patient	-	Gynecologic malignancy	Radical hysterectomy (Donohue)	Stable

New Characters

- **Harlan** (b. November 11, 1944) and **Geneva Moody** (b. May 25, 1947). **Antoinette 'Toni' Graham** (b. October 17, 1971), secretary at P.S. 40, and **Vaughn Graham** (b. December 2, 1967). **Det. Rochelle Ames** (b. September 9, 1964), 103rd Precinct.
- **Ruth Bader Ginsburg**, Faith's greyhound (about 5 years old).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Gordon Parks died March 7, 2006, at 93. Slobodan Milosevic died in his cell at The Hague on March 11, 2006. The Dubai Ports World deal collapsed March 9, 2006, and at the March 5, 2006 Oscars 'Crash' won Best Picture and Three 6 Mafia won Best Original Song. Safe Horizon runs domestic violence shelters in New York City. Palm Beach Kennel Club was a Florida greyhound track.
- Medicine: retained bullets left in place for safety can migrate years later, including into the heart, causing pericardial effusion, tamponade or embolization. Removal from the beating RV uses pledgeted purse-string or mattress sutures placed before extraction. A distal radius fracture plus patterned fingertip bruising and injuries of different ages should prompt intimate partner violence screening, done privately, away from the partner.